

4. Serious kidney failure can be treated using a dialysis machine or by a transplant from a donor. **Table 4.1** shows a fact file about the treatment of kidney failure.

Table 4.1

Fact file – Treatment of Kidney Failure		
	Dialysis	Transplant
Percentage of patients surviving after five years	35	97
Waiting time for treatment	2–3 weeks	3–4 years
Usual time spent in hospital	3 days every week for life	one 5-day stay for an operation
Procedure	needles inserted into blood vessels	major surgery
Drugs	anti-rejection drugs not required	anti-rejection drugs needed for life
Diet	special low-salt foods and restricted fluid intake	normal balanced diet and normal fluid intake
Employment and sports	very limited choice	most types of jobs and many sports can be done



